

Acme Technologies

Employee Handbook

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1. About Acme Technologies

Acme Technologies is a software and cloud services company that develops enterprise applications, artificial intelligence solutions, and cloud infrastructure platforms.

Our employees are expected to act professionally, protect company information, collaborate effectively, and follow all applicable company policies.

2. Working Hours

Employees are expected to work **40 hours per week**.

The standard working schedule is Monday through Friday.

Employees should normally be available between **9:00 AM and 6:00 PM**, with flexibility for lunch and reasonable breaks.

Employees working with international teams may occasionally need to adjust their schedules to accommodate meetings across different time zones.

3. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely when their role and team responsibilities permit remote work.

Remote employees must:

- Maintain a reliable internet connection.
- Protect company equipment from unauthorized access.
- Work from a reasonably secure environment.
- Attend required meetings.
- Follow all company security policies.

Employees who need to work remotely for an extended period should obtain approval from their manager.

4. Annual Leave

Full-time employees receive **24 days of annual leave per calendar year**.

Annual leave should normally be requested at least **five working days in advance**.

Employees should coordinate planned leave with their managers to ensure adequate team coverage.

Unused annual leave may be carried over to the following calendar year, subject to applicable company limits and local employment regulations.

Employees should consult Human Resources for questions about leave balances or carry-over limits.

5. Sick Leave

Employees who are unable to work because of illness should notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible.

For extended periods of illness, the company may request appropriate medical documentation where permitted by applicable law.

Sick leave is intended for genuine health-related absences and should not be used for other purposes.

6. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to company-recognized public holidays applicable to their employment location.

The Human Resources department publishes the official holiday calendar at the beginning of each calendar year.

Employees supporting customers or international teams may occasionally be required to work on a public holiday. Where applicable, compensatory arrangements will be determined by company policy and local regulations.

7. Parental Leave

Eligible employees may receive parental leave in accordance with company policy and applicable local employment laws.

Employees planning parental leave should notify Human Resources and their manager as early as reasonably possible.

The exact duration and benefits associated with parental leave may differ depending on the employee's location and applicable regulations.

8. Employee Benefits

Eligible full-time employees may receive benefits including:

- Health insurance
- Retirement or pension benefits
- Life insurance

- Employee assistance programs
- Professional development support

Benefit eligibility depends on the employee's employment status, location, and applicable benefit plan.

Employees should contact Human Resources for current benefit details.

9. Professional Development

Acme Technologies encourages employees to continuously develop their technical and professional skills.

Employees may request approval for:

- Technical certifications
- Professional courses
- Conferences
- Workshops
- Training programs

The company may reimburse approved professional development expenses according to the applicable budget and reimbursement policy.

Employees should obtain approval **before incurring expenses** if reimbursement is expected.

10. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to behave professionally and respectfully toward colleagues, customers, partners, and other individuals they interact with as part of their work.

Employees must not engage in:

- Harassment
- Discrimination
- Threatening behavior
- Workplace violence
- Fraud
- Theft
- Deliberate misuse of company resources

Employees who believe that a policy violation has occurred should report the matter through the appropriate company reporting channel.

11. Information Security

Employees are responsible for protecting company information.

Employees must:

- Use strong passwords.
- Enable multi-factor authentication where required.
- Lock their computers when unattended.
- Avoid sharing credentials.
- Report suspected security incidents.
- Store confidential information only in approved systems.

Company data must not be copied to unauthorized personal storage services.

12. Password Policy

Employees must use unique passwords for company accounts.

Passwords must not be shared with colleagues, managers, contractors, or external parties.

Where supported, employees must use multi-factor authentication.

If an employee believes that their password has been compromised, they should immediately change the password and notify the security team.

13. Artificial Intelligence Usage

Employees may use company-approved artificial intelligence tools for productivity and development activities.

Employees must not enter confidential, proprietary, customer, financial, security-sensitive, or personally identifiable information into an AI service unless that service has been explicitly approved for the relevant information.

AI-generated content must be reviewed by an employee before being used for important business decisions, customer communications, production code, or official company documents.

Employees remain responsible for the accuracy and appropriateness of content they produce using AI tools.

14. Customer Data

Customer information must be handled according to company security and privacy requirements.

Employees must only access customer data when required for their job responsibilities.

Customer data must not be downloaded, copied, or shared outside approved company systems unless explicitly authorized.

Any suspected unauthorized access to customer data must be reported immediately to the security team.

15. Company Equipment

Employees may be provided with laptops, monitors, mobile devices, security keys, and other equipment required for their work.

Company equipment must be used responsibly and protected from theft or unauthorized access.

Employees must report lost or stolen company equipment to the IT or security team as soon as possible.

Employees leaving the company must return all company-owned equipment.

16. Expense Reimbursement

Employees may request reimbursement for reasonable business expenses incurred while performing authorized company activities.

Expenses should be submitted within **30 days** of the transaction.

Receipts should be provided when required by the expense policy.

Expenses above the applicable approval threshold require manager approval before the expense is incurred.

17. Business Travel

Business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before booking.

Employees should use company-approved travel systems whenever available.

Reasonable transportation, accommodation, and business-related travel expenses may be reimbursed according to the company's travel policy.

Employees should select reasonably priced travel options unless a business requirement justifies an alternative.

18. Performance Reviews

Employees generally participate in a formal performance review **once per year**.

Managers may also conduct periodic check-ins throughout the year.

Performance reviews may consider:

- Job responsibilities

- Quality of work
- Collaboration
- Communication
- Technical skills
- Customer impact
- Achievement of agreed objectives

Performance reviews may contribute to decisions regarding career development, compensation, and promotions.

19. Promotions

Employees may be considered for promotion based on demonstrated performance, skills, responsibilities, business needs, and available opportunities.

Meeting the minimum requirements for a role does not automatically guarantee promotion.

Managers should discuss career development goals with employees during regular performance conversations.

20. Confidential Information

Confidential company information includes information such as:

- Source code
- Product roadmaps
- Internal financial information
- Customer information
- Security information
- Business strategies
- Proprietary technical designs

Employees must not disclose confidential information to unauthorized individuals.

Confidential information must continue to be protected after an employee leaves the company.

21. Intellectual Property

Work products created by employees as part of their employment may belong to Acme Technologies according to applicable employment agreements and laws.

Employees must follow company policies regarding intellectual property, open-source software, patents, trademarks, and copyrighted materials.

Questions regarding intellectual property should be directed to the Legal department.

22. Workplace Communication

Employees should use professional and respectful language in company communications.

Company communication systems may include:

- Email
- Microsoft Teams
- Slack
- Internal ticketing systems
- Project management platforms

Employees should avoid sharing sensitive information through communication channels that are not approved for that information.

23. Incident Reporting

Employees should immediately report suspected security incidents, data breaches, lost company equipment, or unauthorized access.

When reporting an incident, employees should provide:

- A description of the incident
- The approximate time it occurred
- Systems or devices involved
- Relevant screenshots or evidence when appropriate

Employees should not attempt to conceal or deliberately alter evidence related to a security incident.

24. IT Support

Employees experiencing technical problems should contact the IT support team through the company's approved support channel.

Common IT support requests include:

- Password problems
- Laptop issues
- Network connectivity
- Software installation
- Access requests

- Account problems

Critical security incidents should be reported through the security incident process rather than waiting for normal IT support.

25. Employee Separation

Employees leaving the company must complete the applicable offboarding process.

The process may include:

- Returning company equipment
- Transferring work responsibilities
- Revoking access to company systems
- Completing required documentation
- Returning company property

Managers and IT teams are responsible for coordinating appropriate access removal.

26. Human Resources

Employees can contact Human Resources for questions regarding:

- Benefits
- Leave
- Payroll
- Workplace concerns
- Performance processes
- Employment policies
- Career development

Employees should use the official internal HR contact channels for sensitive employment matters.

27. Policy Changes

Acme Technologies may update company policies when business requirements, technology, security practices, or applicable laws change.

Employees are responsible for following the latest published version of company policies.

The Human Resources department is responsible for communicating significant policy changes to employees.

28. Emergency Contacts

For immediate physical safety emergencies, employees should contact the appropriate local emergency services.

For company security incidents, employees should use the company's security incident reporting channel.

For urgent IT issues, employees should use the company's emergency IT support process where applicable.

29. Acknowledgement

Employees are expected to read and understand the policies contained in this handbook.

Employees may be required to acknowledge electronically that they have received and reviewed the current handbook.

Questions regarding interpretation of a policy should be directed to the appropriate department.